shikshagraha

Improving Attendance Through Community Partnership



Ramya Kumar

Rampur village, Sitamarhi district, Bihar

Report of Micro Improvement

★ Problem Statement

Students were unable to attend school regularly due to lack of transport

★ Objective

To improve school attendance by addressing transport difficulties faced by students living far from school

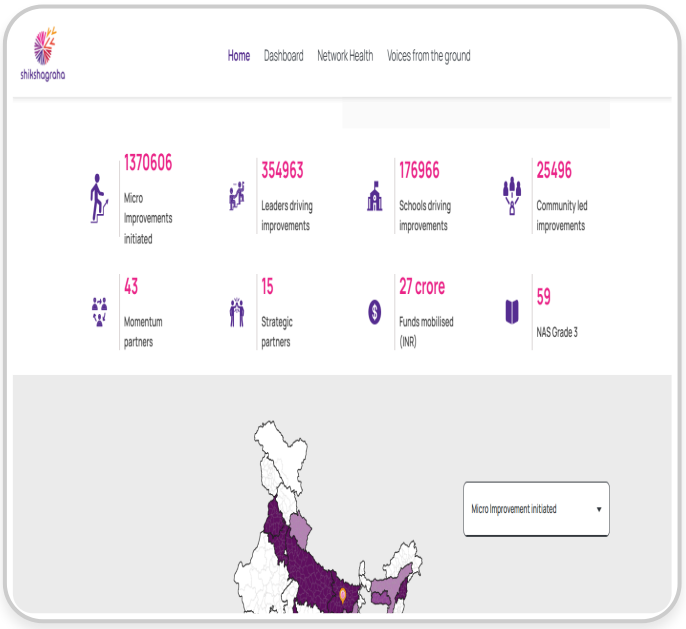
★ Action Steps

1. Identified students facing travel difficulties
2. Met with Gram Panchayat members to request local transport support
3. Arranged a shared auto service for children from distant hamlets
4. Assigned a teacher to supervise pickup points for the first few weeks
5. Parents and Panchayat shared costs

★ Impact

Attendance improved from 68% to over 90%

Story


shikshagraha
Home
Dashboard
Network Health
Voices from the ground
1370606
Micro Improvements initiated
354963
Leaders driving improvements
176966
Schools driving improvements
25496
Community led improvements
43
Momentum partners
15
Strategic partners
27 crore
Funds mobilised (INR)
59
NAS Grade 3
Micro Improvement initiated

Improving Attendance Through Community Partnership

Ramya Kumar, the Headmaster of Government Primary School in Rampur village, Sitamarhi district, Bihar, noticed that many students were unable to attend school regularly due to the lack of transport. Some students had to travel 3-5 kilometers to reach school, often on foot, as there were no regular public buses or autos in the area. Parents were busy with daily wage work and couldn't accompany their children every day.

To address this issue, Ramya discussed it in the School Management Committee meeting and identified students facing travel difficulties. She then met with the Gram Panchayat members and requested local transport support. With their help, a shared auto service was arranged for children from distant hamlets. The Panchayat covered fuel costs once a week, and parents contributed a small monthly amount. Teachers coordinated pickup and drop timings to ensure children reached school safely.

Initially, parents were hesitant to send their children in a shared vehicle. To overcome this, a teacher was assigned to supervise the pickup point for the first few weeks. Once parents saw that it was safe, they became supportive. The entire process, from planning to full implementation, took around two months.

The outcome was positive, with attendance improving from around 68% to over 90%. Children became more regular and punctual, and parents felt relieved and more connected to the school. Ramya learned that community partnerships are key to removing barriers to education. Even small steps like arranging shared transport can make a significant difference.

The experience also showed that with collective efforts, it's possible to address significant challenges. The Gram Panchayat provided local support and a vehicle connection, while parents contributed financially and helped maintain discipline. Teachers played a crucial role in managing timings and supervising the pickup point.

Ramya plans to continue working on improving education in her school and community. She believes that by sharing her experience, she can inspire others to take similar initiatives. Ramya is happy to share her school's experience and hopes that it will contribute to the improvement of education in other schools and communities.